Press coverage insights: Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel

Workbook: `AJG Coverage - NewsBank.xlsx`, saved 2026-11-05. Read-only analysis; nothing in the workbook was changed.

"Story" below means an Original row (one piece of reporting). "Reprint" means the same piece run again elsewhere (a wire story in another paper, a chain's sister papers, a Nexstar clip on another station). Verbatim reposts of his own releases are not counted as coverage. Counts for October–November 2026 are not final (see Caveats).

1. Summary: the eight most useful takeaways

1. **Food safety is the franchise.** One topic produces 23% of all stories (891 of 3,832) and 47% of all release-driven coverage. Every one of the 24 food-safety releases got coverage (median 20 stories each); everything else combined gets a median of 2 stories per release. AB 418 alone: 470 stories plus 609 reprints.
2. **Three in four releases get at least one story, but most get only one to three.** 236 official releases since 2018: 178 (75%) have at least one related story; 40 (17%) produced nothing at all. The median release earns 2 stories and 1 reprint.
3. **Releases tied to a bill milestone work; ceremonial and "passed the Assembly" releases don't.** Signing releases average 9 stories, introduction releases 9, "passes the Assembly/Senate" 6 (median 2; outside food safety, median 1). Honors and award releases: 1 of 7 got any story. District/community releases: 18 issued, 1 story each on average.
4. **A bill milestone with a release gets roughly 5 to 10 times the coverage of the same milestone without one.** Signed with a release: every one covered, median 5 stories. Signed without a release: 58% covered, median 1. Introduced with a release: 88% covered; without: 5%.
5. **The statewide political press is the core audience and it reports independently.** Politico (183 stories), Sacramento Bee (153), CalMatters (106), LA Times (105) lead all-time; only 10% of Politico's and 11% of CalMatters' stories trace back to a release. The Jewish press (Jewish Journal 104, J. 57, San Diego Jewish World 44, Jewish Insider 40) is the second pillar and the most favorable (about 40% positive).
6. **Coverage is mostly neutral and the negatives are concentrated.** 76% of rated stories are Neutral, 16% Positive, 4.5% Negative. Negative stories cluster on guns (18% of gun stories) and in a handful of outlets (California Globe 16, OC Register 9, gun-rights sites). 2026 has the highest positive share in years (23%), driven by national food-policy profiles.
7. **Reach and quoting are slipping even as volume holds.** Stories per year: 764 (2023), 714, 642, 607 (2026 to date). The share with a Gabriel quote fell from 52% (2023) to 41% (2026), and the national/international share from 27% to 18%, as more stories mention him only as Budget chair.
8. **Timing: September and October carry a third of the year.** Stories per month-of-year (2019–2026): September 586, October 540, March 430; November to February 150–250 each. Monday and Tuesday releases do best; Wednesday and Thursday releases do worst (competing Capitol news); Friday releases are picked up but the stories land later.

2. Press release performance

How pickup was counted

- **Releases:** the Press releases tab, in-scope rows only (236 of 244): 199 from gabriel.asmdc.org (June 2018 – October 2026) and 37 Legislative Jewish Caucus releases from his chair tenure. 201 are press releases, 31 statements, 4 other (a letter, a constituent update, an event notice, a "What they're saying" roundup).

- **Related stories:** the tracker's release matcher (`code/release_related.json`, the same data behind the tab's "Related count"). A story counts as related to a release when it (a) ran or quoted the release text (a run of 25+ identical words), or (b) covered the same announcement in the release's coverage window (same bill and subject within about a week, same names and figures, or a roundup mention). Later coverage weeks afterwards and "possible" matches are not counted.
- **Pickup rate** = share of releases with at least one related story. **Stories** = related Originals; **reprints** = their reprints.
- **Copies** = verbatim reposts of his release (130 rows: Targeted News Service, US Fed News, San Diego Jewish World, Sierra Sun Times, PublicNow and similar). They are hidden in the tracker and counted separately, not as coverage.

Reliability of the links. The "ran or quoted the text" links are mechanical and reliable (High). The "same announcement" links were hand-checked at 95%+ on samples when built (Medium: a few stories about a bill will be credited to a release that merely coincided with the news). Only stories with saved text can be text-tested, so a few no-copy stories (LA Times, Politico, AP) that used release wording are under-counted. A release's count cannot exceed the tracker's own coverage, so the gaps described in Caveats (print, TV, newest weeks) apply here too.

Headline numbers (2018–2026)

	Value
Releases in scope	236 (about 30 a year since 2021)
Releases with at least one related story	178 (75%)
Releases with only verbatim copies	18 (8%)
Releases with nothing	40 (17%)
Related stories (distinct)	1,223 = 32% of all stories; 36% of stories since 2021
… that ran or quoted the release text	501 stories (14% of stories since 2021)
… that covered the same news independently	about 760
Reprints of related stories	1,421
Stories per release	median 2, mean 5.4; 32 releases reached 10+
Speed	first story on the release day or earlier for 57% of releases with pickup; by the next day 78%; within a week 91%

By kind of release

Kind (from the title)	Releases	Got coverage	Stories per release (mean / median)	Reprints (mean)
Governor signs	40	85%	8.8 / 3	14
Introduces legislation	20	85%	9.5 / 3	9
Passes the Assembly or Senate	28	64%	6.5 / 2 (outside food safety: 57%, median 1)	7
Statement / responds / comments	19	84%	3.5 / 2	4
Secures or announces funding	4	75%	3.0 / 2.5	2
Honors (Woman/Small Business of the Year etc.)	7	14%	0.1 / 0	0
Everything else	118	75%	3.9 / 1.5	3

Statements (31 by the tab's type) get coverage as often as press releases (77% vs 76%) but less of it (median 2). The ones that worked rode big news: the AB 587 statement on X/Twitter's lawsuit (27 stories, 25 reprints), the CSU

chancellor statement (10), the DNC convention storming (8), the January 2026 budget statement with the Speaker (8). Routine budget-revise statements get 1–5 stories, usually as a quote inside someone else's budget story.

By topic

Issue	Releases	Got coverage	Median stories	Mean stories	Mean reprints
Food safety	24	100%	19.5	24.6	30
Social media / tech	8	88%	6.5	9.8	7
Guns	21	81%	5	7.0	12
Restaurants / outdoor dining	9	89%	5	5.1	3
State budget	17	76%	2	3.6	4
Antisemitism / Jewish community	49	84%	2	3.1	3
Public safety	12	75%	2.5	2.4	0.3
Wildfire / looting	5	60%	1	3.8	6
Immigration	6	50%	2	3.5	3
Housing / homelessness	24	67%	1	1.6	3
Education	10	70%	1	1.2	1
District / community	18	61%	1	1.0	0.6
Leadership / committee posts	7	43%	0	0.7	0
Health / labor	6	50%	0.5	0.8	2

Antisemitism is the most frequent release subject (49, a fifth of all) and gets steady but small pickup, almost all in the Jewish press. Housing is the second most frequent (24) and among the weakest performers.

By year

Year	Releases	Got coverage	Mean stories	Mean reprints	Note
2019	15	53%	1.8	1.5	
2020	15	53%	0.9	0.9	COVID year
2021	39	79%	2.5	2.9	
2022	33	64%	2.8	1.2	
2023	37	84%	10.1	14.1	AB 418 (Skittles)
2024	34	88%	7.6	7.8	AB 2316 (school food)
2025	28	75%	7.2	8.6	AB 1264, Glock ban
2026	33	85%	6.0	6.1	AB 2244 (state seal); October–November not final

Excluding food safety, the typical release has earned a median of 2 stories every year since 2021; the yearly swings are all food safety.

Other patterns

- **A bill in the release matters.** Releases naming a bill: 81% pickup vs 59% without (outside food safety 78% vs 54%; this difference is unlikely to be chance).
- **Joint releases with another legislator: no measurable gain.** 99 joint vs 137 solo: 76% vs 75% pickup; outside food safety joint releases average 3.7 stories vs 2.8 (median 2 vs 1), a difference well within chance. Releases with three or more legislators (caucus group releases) do worse: 58% pickup, 2 stories. Senator Wiener is the co-issuer on 34 (caucus releases).

- **Length:** releases over 700 words get coverage 85% of the time vs about 73% for shorter ones, a weak pattern that mostly reflects bigger announcements being longer.
- **Office vs caucus:** office releases 76% pickup, mean 5.9 stories; Jewish Caucus 73%, mean 2.5.
- **Who runs releases verbatim:** Targeted News Service (161 copies, all releases), US Fed News (41), San Diego Jewish World (16), PublicNow (16), Lassen County Times (13), Sierra Sun Times (12), Contra Costa News (8), East County Today (8), Van Nuys News Press (6). These are reach, not reporting.

Releases that earned nothing (2023 onward, 17 of 134)

Date	Release	Why it probably failed
2023-04-18	Jewish Caucus observes Yom HaShoah	ceremonial
2023-06-07	Honors New Economics for Women (Nonprofit of the Year)	honor
2023-08-25	Secures $2M for New Economics for Women	local funding, no bill
2023-12-11	Caucus urges President Biden on hostages	national subject, no state hook
2024-02-27	Caucus condemns antisemitic violence on UC campuses (statement)	crowded news
2024-05-23	Assembly passes AB 2432 (crime victims)	"passes the Assembly"
2024-05-28	Advances 14 bills to the Senate	bundle, no quote
2024-10-02	Governor signs all four caucus priority bills	bundle; the bills were covered individually earlier
2025-06-04	Assembly passes AB 468 (looting penalties)	"passes the Assembly"
2025-06-06	Caucus statement on ICE raids	no quote; crowded news
2025-07-16	Agreement to advance AB 468	procedural
2025-09-09	Legislature passes wage-theft bill (AB 1002)	late-session flood
2025-09-09	Legislature passes two small-restaurant bills (AB 592)	late-session flood
2026-05-07	Assembly Democrats' budget road map	caucus product, not his
2026-05-11	"What they're saying" on budget priorities	roundup
2026-05-27	AB 1806 advances (immigration enforcement)	procedural; the bill got 21 stories at other points
2026-05-28	Assembly passes AB 2204 (Second Chance Sports Act)	"passes the Assembly"

Across all years the 40 silent releases are: District/community 7, Antisemitism 5, Housing 4, Guns 3, Education 3, Leadership posts 3, the rest scattered.

Patterns worth acting on

1. Put the release effort on signings and introductions, where a release roughly quintuples coverage (section 7). Treat "passed the Assembly" as a social-media post unless the vote itself is news.
2. Honors, ceremonial and bundle releases ("14 bills advance", "four bills signed") earn nothing in the press; if they must go out, pair them with a pitch to one Valley outlet rather than a general send.
3. Housing releases are frequent (24) and weak (median 1 story). Either attach them to a hard milestone or fold them into fewer, larger packages.
4. Avoid the second week of September for anything that can wait: the 2025-09-09 pair of "Legislature passes" releases sank in the end-of-session flood, while the same bills got coverage at signing a month later.

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3. Best day of the week to issue a release

What the data can and cannot say. The tab records dates, not times, so "Friday afternoon vs Monday morning" cannot be tested. The weekday is also largely dictated by events: Saturday and Sunday releases (12 in total) are almost all

governor's signings and legislative passage, and they are the biggest of all (mean 17 stories) for that reason, not because of the day. The comparison below therefore uses ordinary press releases from 2021 on, excluding food safety, so the big-event days don't swamp it (about 150 releases).

Day issued	Releases	Got coverage	Stories per release (median / mean)	Reprints (mean)	Share of stories within 2 days
Monday	20	95%	3 / 5.0	3.9	72%
Tuesday	42	76%	2 / 4.0	5.0	68%
Wednesday	29	59%	2 / 2.4	2.5	67%
Thursday	28	71%	1.5 / 2.5	1.5	54%
Friday	27	89%	3 / 4.3	6.5	32%

- Wednesday and Thursday releases do measurably worse (fewer stories; p = 0.03 against the other days). These are the Capitol's busiest days for competing news.
- Monday is the strongest day for pickup rate and speed; Friday matches it on pickup and stories but the coverage arrives later (median 3 days after the release vs 1 day for Monday/Tuesday; only a third of Friday-release stories appear within two days). Friday's reprint count is high because weekend editions re-run stories.
- Within single issues the ordering holds loosely (antisemitism: Friday 88% vs Mon–Thu 81%; guns: Friday 100% vs 75%), but the samples are 3–8 releases each.

Strength of evidence: Medium-Low. The Wednesday/Thursday dip is the only difference unlikely to be chance; the Monday and Friday advantages are suggestive (p = 0.16 and 0.39), there is no time-of-day data, and the weekday is confounded with what kind of news it was.

Plain recommendation: when the day is yours to choose, issue on Monday or Tuesday morning; avoid Wednesday and Thursday; use Friday only for news that benefits from a slower weekend build (features, local follow-ups), and expect the stories on Monday.

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4. Releases with a Gabriel quote vs without

How quotes were identified. The tab's "Gabriel quoted" column (Yes on 221 of 236 in-scope releases) was checked against the release texts in `code/release_texts.json` by looking for a quoted passage with "Gabriel" within a sentence of it. The two agree on 213 of 236; the 10 "Yes" rows my search missed are caucus statements where the quote is attributed to "the Caucus" or to "Gabriel and Wiener" jointly, and the tab is right. Whether outlets used his words comes from the Coverage tab's Quoted column (Yes only when his own words appear in quotation marks) on the related stories.

Only 15 in-scope releases have no quote from him: the Giffords visit (2019), two COVID notices, four caucus statements, the diversity-caucuses statement on the LA City Council tapes, the Morgan Freeman school-food endorsement list, two "advances N bills" bundles, the private-judges bill passing, the hostages letter, and the 2026 "What they're saying" roundup.

	No Gabriel quote	With a Gabriel quote
Releases	15	221
Got coverage	47%	77%
Stories per release (median / mean)	0 / 1.5	2 / 5.6
Same, excluding food safety	0 / 1.6 (14 releases)	2 / 3.3 (198)
Reprints (mean)	1.6	6.3
Statewide or national stories per release	0.8	1.9
First story the same day	57%	57%

	No Gabriel quote	With a Gabriel quote
Related stories that quote him (Quoted = Yes)	42%	66%
Related stories that reuse release wording	44%	45%

- Excluding food safety, the pickup gap (43% vs 75%) is unlikely to be chance (p = 0.02); the story-count gap is suggestive (p = 0.16). Solo releases only: 38% vs 72%. Jewish Caucus releases only: 57% vs 77%.
- Across all coverage since 2021, release-linked stories quote him 69% of the time; stories with no release behind them 35%. The release quote is what gets him quoted.
- Quote length (among quoted releases, outside food safety): 1–60 words of his quote, 62% pickup; 61–120 words, 75%; over 120 words, 80%. A long quote slightly helps pickup but the stories reuse less of it (38% of related stories reuse release wording vs 74% for short quotes), so a punchy 60–120-word quote is the sweet spot.

Confidence: Medium. The direction is consistent across every cut, but there are only 15 unquoted releases and they are also disproportionately the weak kinds (bundles, letters, ceremonial), so the quote is partly a marker of a real announcement rather than the cause.

Recommendation: never send a release without a quotable 2–3 sentence line from him; keep the quote to about 60–120 words with one sentence that can stand alone, because that is the sentence the Bee, KCRA and the Jewish press lift.

5. Other actionable insights

Outlets that cover him most

All-time stories (Originals) and the last 12 months (Nov 2025 – Nov 2026):

Outlet	All-time	Last 12 months	2024	Release-driven share (2021+)
Politico (incl. Pro and Playbook)	206	42	54	10%
Sacramento Bee	153	30	23	30%
CalMatters	106	17	26	11%
Los Angeles Times	105	6	28	40%
Jewish Journal (LA)	104	16	8	18%
San Francisco Chronicle	65	11	20	45%
J. The Jewish News (NorCal)	57	7	8	30%
Epoch Times	56	3	11	39%
Los Angeles Daily News	55	5	3	27%
Orange County Register	45	3	9	30%
San Diego Jewish World	44	13	8	9% (but runs copies)
Courthouse News Service	40	6	12	43%
California Globe	40	7	1	60% (and 40% negative)
Jewish Insider	40	2	2	8%
Center Square California	25	12	2	28%
Sing Tao Daily (Chinese)	26	10	9	15%
KCRA 3 / ABC10 / FOX40 (Sacramento TV)	70	22	12	about 40%

"Release-driven share" is the share of the outlet's stories linked to one of his releases; the rest is independent reporting. Politico, CalMatters, Jewish Insider, Pasadena Star-News (3%), Asbarez and California Courier (0%) report on

him without his releases; KTLA (76%), MailOnline (72%), Food Safety News (94%), CBS News (68%), ABC7 LA (80%), Adelante Valle (65%) and La Opinión (50%) mostly come via a release or the news it made.

Rising in the last year: Center Square (12), Sing Tao (10), ABC10 (10), City Hall Pass (8), Hoodline (8), Bay Area Reporter (7), Politico Pro (7), LA County Politics newsletter (6), State Affairs Pro (6).

Reporters

Most stories all-time: Lara Korte 50 (Politico/Bee; none since Oct 2024), Dustin Gardiner 48 (Politico; 5 in the last year), Ryan Torok 47 (Jewish Journal; 2), Lindsey Holden 34 (Bee/Politico; 2), Alan Riquelmy 31 (Courthouse News; 5), Andrew Sheeler 30 (Bee; none since 2024), Aaron Bandler 26 (Jewish Journal/JNS; 3), Jeremy B. White 33 (Politico; 4), Linh Tat 23 (SCNG; 6), Lynn La 23 (CalMatters; 3), Blake Jones 19 (Politico; 7).

Most active in the last 12 months: Andrew Graham (Bee, 11), Madeline Shannon (Center Square, 11), Yue Stella Yu (CalMatters, 8), Blake Jones (Politico, 7), Stephen Hobbs (Bee, 6), Linh Tat (SCNG, 6), Melanie Mason (Politico, 6), Antonio Ray Harvey (California Black Media, 5), Teresa Liu (LA Daily News, 5), Jenny Huh (ABC10, 5), Lia Russell (Bee, 5), Ashley Zavala (KCRA, 4), Kate Wolffe (Bee/CapRadio, 4), Donald H. Harrison (SD Jewish World, 4), Niva Ashkenazi (J., 4). The Sacramento Bee's state desk has turned over almost entirely since 2024 (Korte, Sheeler, Wiley gone; Graham, Hobbs, Russell, Williams new). 27% of stories carry no named author.

Topics and bills that drive coverage

Stories by topic, all-time: Food safety 891, Antisemitism/Jewish community 580, State budget 393, Guns 302, Elections 268, Social media/tech 151, Housing 147, Immigration 101, Wildfire 100, Education 100, Restaurants 87, Public safety 84, Energy 84.

By year the mix has shifted: food safety fell from 334 (2023) to about 160–180 a year; State budget rose from 10 (2023) to 141 (2024) and 119 (2026) with the Budget chair role; Immigration jumped to 42 in 2026 (AB 1806, federal enforcement); Guns spiked in 2023 (AB 28 gun tax, 115) and 2025 (AB 1127 Glock ban, 72); Social media peaked in 2022–23 (AB 587) and is gone.

Bills by stories (plus reprints): AB 418 food additives 470 (+609), AB 1264 ultra-processed school food 283 (+157), AB 2316 school food dyes 265 (+252), AB 28 gun tax 128 (+191), AB 2244 state seal 115 (+67), AB 587 social media 112 (+110), AB 1127 Glock 90 (+143), AB 1185 nonprofit security 47, AB 61 outdoor dining 45, AB 2867 Nazi-looted art 44 (+78), AB 1548 security grants 39, AB 1836 38, AB 1305 33, AB 1664 32, AB 2432 25, ACA 20 rainy-day fund 23 (+24), AB 715 23, AB 468 21, AB 1806 21. Half of all stories (1,904) name one of his bills.

Budget-chair coverage (393 stories) is large but shallow: 5% positive, and it is where the "named, not quoted" growth comes from.

Tone

Of 3,704 rated stories: Neutral 79%, Positive 16%, Very positive 0.5%, Negative 4.5%, Very negative 0.3%. Reprints carry their original's tone.

- **By topic:** District/community 32% positive, Food safety 23%, Antisemitism 21%, Restaurants 21%, Housing 20%, Public safety 20%. Guns 17% negative (54 stories), Social media 10%, Housing 7%, Education 6%, Budget 5%, Antisemitism 4%.
- **By outlet:** most positive are the Jewish press (Jewish Journal 41%, SD Jewish World 41%, J. 37%) and the Valley/local papers (Adelante Valle 59%, SFV Sun 44%, Beverly Press 41%, Contra Costa News 35%). Most negative: California Globe 40% (16 stories), Center Square 16%, OC Register 20% (opinion page), Epoch Times 7%, CalMatters 6%, LA Times 4%. Politico, the Bee and the Chronicle are over 95% neutral.
- **The 10 very negative pieces** are opinion: gun-rights sites on the Glock ban (Bearing Arms, Truth About Guns, Gun Owners of California), California Globe on the budget and the Glock ban, LA Progressive on AB 715, a Substack on the Jewish Caucus, Techdirt on AB 587, WorldNetDaily (2019), an Acorn guest column (2023).

- **2026 is the most positive year** (132 Positive + 10 Very positive of 607): FERN's "America's de facto food safety chief", Consumed, Web Chef, nutrition podcasts, the Bee editorial board on Prop 2, Jewish Journal.

Non-English and regional coverage

411 stories (11%) are not in English, plus 92 reprints. Peak 2023 (107 stories, the Skittles bill went global), 92 in 2024, 53 in 2025, 67 in 2026 so far.

Language	Stories	Outlets	2025–26	Main outlets	Main topics
Spanish	179	54	41	Adelante Valle 33 (none in 2026), La Opinión 28, SFV Sun bilingual 11, La Nación 11, Infobae 9, Telemundo 52 7, Univision 14 6, El Sol del Valle 5	Food safety 56, Antisemitism 17, Guns
Chinese	113	24	37	Epoch Times 36 (13 in 2023, 3 in 2026), Sing Tao Daily 26 (10 in 2026, rising), NTD 9, World Journal 4	Food safety 43, roundups 36, Guns 10
Korean	49	30	15	Korea Daily 9, Korea Times 4, Yonhap 3; the rest one-offs	roundups 20, Food safety 18
Hebrew	21	7	6	Hebrew News (LA) 15	roundups, food, Jewish community, district items
Russian	17	17	7	one-offs, food-safety syndication	Food safety 8
Persian	11	9	5	Iranshahr 3	Food safety, social media
Vietnamese	10	4	6	Nguoi-Viet 5	Food safety
Others	11			French 4, Portuguese 2, Armenian 1 (Oragark), Hindi, German, Italian, Kyrgyz 1 each	mostly the Sept 2026 FERN profile syndication

- **Non-English coverage follows the English wave, not the release.** 74% of non-English stories have an English story on the same topic or bill in the previous 7 days; 37% are linked to a release (Spanish 49%, Chinese 28%, Korean 29%), and none ran his release text as such, which is expected because releases go out only in English. Their lag from the release is the same as English stories (median 2 days).
- **The Armenian press covers him in English:** Asbarez 28 and California Courier 28 stories (9 each in 2025–26), mostly roundups and election coverage, none release-driven. Only one Armenian-language story exists.
- **Spanish is drifting away from local outlets.** Adelante Valle (Imperial Valley, a CalMatters Spanish partner) and the SFV Sun's bilingual pieces carried most Spanish coverage in 2022–24; in 2025–26 the Spanish stories are mostly international wires (Infobae, La Nación) on food safety. La Opinión is down to 1–3 a year.
- Tone in non-English coverage: 76% neutral, 23% positive, 1% negative; he is quoted in 43% of these stories, about the same as in English.

TV, radio and podcasts

338 TV, 76 radio and 14 podcast stories, plus 503 TV reprints (Nexstar and CBS clips re-run across stations). TV stories by year: 84 (2023), 74, 62, 36 (2026 to date), a real decline and also a capture gap (archive.org TV captions, untitled segments). Sacramento stations now lead: KCRA 25 all-time (11 in 2025–26), ABC10 24 (17), FOX40 21 (9); LA stations have faded: KTLA 22 (1 in 2026), ABC7 LA 18 (0 in 2026), Spectrum News 1 30 (2 in 2026), KRON 4 19 (none since Sept 2024). Radio is steady at 15–18 a year: KQED 16, CapRadio 16, KNX 9, 790 KABC 4. Podcasts rose to 9 in 2026, all food and nutrition shows (Dr. Hyman, Dan Buettner, American Dish, Spilled Milk) and all positive or very positive. Broadcast stories quote him more often than print (59% vs 44%).

Timing and the legislative calendar

- Stories per month-of-year (2019–2026 combined): Jan 251, Feb 185, Mar 430, Apr 232, May 290, Jun 313, Jul 186, Aug 285, Sep 586, Oct 540, Nov 151, Dec 163. End of session and the signing deadline (Sept–Oct) are a third of the year; bill introductions (March), the May Revise and the June budget are the other peaks.

- Releases follow the same curve (Sept 44, May 29, Oct 28, Aug 27; Nov–Dec 6–7) so the quiet months (November to February) have little going out and little coming in. In 2025–26 the January budget proposal and the LA fires (Jan 2025: 92 stories) show the winter can carry news when there is a hook.
- Stories appear Wednesday and Thursday most (764 and 755), Saturday and Sunday least (about 10% together).

Reprint and syndication chains

951 stories (25%) were reprinted at least once, 3.8 times on average; 79% of reprints appear the same or next day, 96% within a week.

- **Biggest multipliers:** AP (295 reprints from 15 stories, 20 each), CalMatters (531 from 73, 7 each, into LAist, Press Democrat, Lake County Record-Bee, San Mateo Daily Journal, Davis Enterprise, Lompoc Record, Santa Maria Times), USA Today network (73 from 6; the Glock court-challenge story ran in 48 papers), East Bay Times/Mercury News (BANG, 224), the Bee and McClatchy (218; Napa Valley Register, Modesto, Fresno), the Southern California News Group (OC Register, Pasadena Star-News, Daily Breeze, LA Daily News, Press-Telegram, SGV Tribune, Whittier, Sun, Inland Valley, Press-Enterprise, Redlands: a story in one runs in 4–8), KTLA/FOX40 (Nexstar: 114 and 65 reprints across stations), Jewish Telegraphic Agency and JNS into the Jewish weeklies (Columbus Jewish News 23), MailOnline into the Daily Mail, Yahoo News (143, mostly LA Times and AP).
- Practical use: one AP, CalMatters, USA Today or SCNG story is worth 5–20 placements; one Jewish Journal story is usually one placement.

Gaps and opportunities

- **Outlets that used to cover him and have gone quiet:** LA Times 28 (2024) → 17 (2025) → 2 (2026) (partly a capture problem: it blocks the web search and arrives via NewsBank, but worth a check); KRON 4 (19, none since Sept 2024); ABC7 San Francisco (12, last March 2025); The Acorn (19 Valley stories, none since Aug 2023); The Hill (9, last Feb 2025); Epoch Times (18 in 2023, 3 in 2026); Beverly Press (none since May 2025); Adelante Valle (15 in 2023, 0 in 2026); the Forward (none since 2022).
- **District and Valley press is thin:** 152 stories all-time with a District & Valley reach, and the SFV Sun fell from 11 (2024) to 2 (2026). Most Valley residents see him through SCNG reprints of Sacramento stories.
- **Topics with coverage but few releases:** State budget (393 stories, 17 releases), Elections (268, none), Immigration (101 stories, 6 releases; 42 in 2026), Wildfire (100, 5). The Budget chair role generates coverage on its own; the question is whether it is the coverage wanted (5% positive, mostly "named").
- **Topics with releases but little coverage:** District/community (18 releases, 18 stories), Housing (24 releases, median 1), Education (10, median 1), Leadership posts.
- **Food policy profiles are a new lane:** the September 2026 FERN profile was re-run in 8 languages and prompted Consumed, Web Chef and three nutrition podcasts.

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6. Op-eds by Gabriel

How they were identified. Rows with Role = "Op-ed by Gabriel" (8 stories, 19 rows with reprints) plus any row whose byline contains "Jesse Gabriel", then dropping the Sierra Sun Times and Del Norte Triplicate rows, which print his releases under his name as the byline (those are release copies, not op-eds). A search of opinion-section rows and "Commentary" headlines found no others. Result: 8 op-eds, 4 of them since he took office in 2018.

Date	Outlet (reach)	Subject	Co-author	Reprints
2026-10-13	CalMatters (statewide)	Prop 2 / rainy-day fund	Asm. Josh Hoover (R)	7: Bakersfield Californian, Santa Maria Times, Santa Monica Daily Press, The Record, KFN (English and Spanish)
2020-02-19	Pasadena Star-News	homelessness prevention		3: Daily Breeze, Press-Telegram, LA Daily News

Date	Outlet (reach)	Subject	Co-author	Reprints
2020-02-12	Jewish Journal	the Jewish Caucus	Sen. Ben Allen	1: J.
2019-07-16	Sacramento Bee	affordability		0
2017-06-01	Jewish Journal	Six-Day War voices (pre-office)		0
2017-05-17	Jewish Journal	Dreamers (pre-office)		0
2017-05-02	Wall Street Journal (national)	Dreamers' due process (pre-office)	Theodore Boutrous	0
2016-06-15	Jewish Journal	BDS (pre-office)	Scott Edelman	1

- **Performance:** a CalMatters or SCNG op-ed syndicates to 3–7 papers on its own, which is as much reach as a typical release earns (median 2 stories, 1 reprint), with his words intact.
- **Follow-on coverage:** none measurable. Same-topic stories in the 14 days after vs the 14 days before: CalMatters 2026, 3 after vs 9 before (Prop 2 coverage was already peaking); Pasadena 2020, 4 vs 3; the others 0–1 either way. With four in-office op-eds the question cannot be answered properly; op-eds are too rare here to have a track record.
- **Others' op-eds about him** are the positive ones: Christina Pascucci in the Daily Breeze on children's nutrition (very positive), Mike Feuer in the Bee on the Glock bill, the Bee editorial board on Prop 2, Giffords in the Lassen County Times.
- **Opportunity:** roughly one op-ed every two years is far below what the subjects support. CalMatters commentary (with its partner network), the Bee's opinion page, the Jewish Journal and the Daily News opinion page have all run him. Food policy, where national outlets now profile him, has never had an op-ed from him.

Confidence: High on the list, Low on performance (4 cases).

7. Does X lead to more coverage?

Each test compares his bills' coverage around an event (stories naming the bill from the day before to 7 days after). Bills tab milestones, 2021 onward, his bills only.

Milestone	Events	Any story	Mean / median stories	With a release (−1 to +2 days): any / mean / median	Without a release: any / mean / median
Introduced	212	10%	0.3 / 0	8 events: 88% / 3.2 / 3	204: 5% / 0.2 / 0
Assembly floor vote	162	20%	0.5 / 0	20: 60% / 2.4 / 1.5	142: 14% / 0.2 / 0
Senate floor vote	93	30%	2.0 / 0	16: 81% / 7.2 / 1.5	77: 26% / 0.9 / 0
Passed both houses	90	40%	2.1 / 0	24: 79% / 6.8 / 2	66: 20% / 0.5 / 0
Signed	74	80%	6.6 / 2.5	36: 100% / 12.1 / 5	38: 58% / 1.4 / 1
Vetoed	8	25%	0.2 / 0	none had a release	

- **A release at a milestone goes with 5–10 times the coverage.** Part of this is selection (releases go out on the bills that matter), but the introduction numbers (88% vs 5%) and the signing numbers (median 5 vs 1) are too large for selection alone. Confidence: Medium-High.

- **Signing is the single best moment**, then introduction (if there is a story angle: Skittles, Glock, Tom Colicchio), then final passage. Floor votes in the first house are near-invisible without a hook.
- **Vetoes get no coverage** (2 of 8), and there has never been a veto release.
- **Joint releases:** no gain (section 2). Caucus-wide releases (3+ names) do worse.
- **A quote from him:** a release without one is picked up about half as often (section 4).
- **TV appearances:** after 111 broadcasts where he was the featured guest, same-topic stories in the next 7 days averaged 15 vs 10 in the 7 days before (61% of cases rose). This cannot be separated from the fact that he is booked when a story is already hot. Confidence: Low.
- **Statements reacting to news** get coverage 77% of the time but only when the news is big (Twitter lawsuit 27 stories); routine budget statements get 1–5, nearly always as a quote inside a budget story. They are cheap and worth sending for the quote.
- **Events and honors** (Day of Service, Woman of the Year, ribbon cuttings): 1 story in 7 releases. Local events reach the Valley papers only when pitched directly; the general send does nothing.

8. Key statistics

Statistic	Value	Period	Confidence	Why
Stories (Originals) in the tracker	3,832 (+3,591 reprints)	1993–Nov 2026; 95% from 2018	High for 2023+, Medium before	search began in 2023 retroactively; pre-2018 thin
Stories per year	764 / 714 / 642 / 607	2023 / 2024 / 2025 / 2026 to Nov 4	Medium	web search misses about 1 in 6 until the NewsBank refresh; 2026 not final
Stories in the last 12 months	about 650 (+560 reprints)	Nov 2025–Nov 2026	Medium	newest weeks incomplete
Distinct outlets per year	about 280–330	2023–2026	Medium	one-off syndication outlets inflate 2023
Share of stories that quote him	46% all-time; 52% (2023) → 41% (2026)		Medium-High	mechanical quote check misses some comma-style attributions
Share where he is featured or quoted (depth)	50%; "named only" 41%; list-only 4%	all	Medium	depth is rule-coded
Tone: Neutral / Positive / Negative (incl. very)	79% / 16% / 4.7% (of 3,704 rated)	all	Medium	Claude-rated with a rubric; straight news is neutral by rule; 128 unrated
Food safety share of stories	23% (891)	all	High	bill-tag driven
AB 418 coverage	470 stories + 609 reprints	2023–2026	High	
Releases in scope	236 (about 30 a year)	2018–2026	High	official sites only; no other channels counted
Releases with at least one story	75%	2018–2026	Medium-High	text links reliable; same-news links hand-checked at 95%+
Releases with no coverage at all	17% (40)	2018–2026	Medium	a few may have no-copy coverage that couldn't be text-tested
Stories per release	median 2, mean 5.4; food safety median 20	2018–2026	Medium	

Statistic	Value	Period	Confidence	Why
Share of all stories linked to a release	36% (14% reuse the text)	2021–2026	Medium	
First story within a day of the release	78% of releases with pickup		Medium	matcher windows cap how late a link can be
Releases without a Gabriel quote: pickup	47% vs 77% with		Medium	15 cases
Signing with a release vs without	median 5 vs 1 stories; 100% vs 58% covered	2021–2026	Medium-High	selection effect partly
Introduction with a release vs without	88% vs 5% covered	2021–2026	Medium	8 cases with a release
Best weekday to release	Monday/Tuesday; worst Wednesday/Thursday	2021–2026, non-food releases	Low-Medium	no times; small cells; only the Wed/Thu dip is statistically clear
Non-English stories	411 (11%); Spanish 179, Chinese 113, Korean 49	all	Medium	non-English capture improved only in Nov 2026
TV stories per year	84 → 74 → 62 → 36	2023–2026	Low-Medium	TV is the hardest to catch; untitled segments missed
Top outlets (all-time)	Politico 183, Bee 153, CalMatters 106, LA Times 105, Jewish Journal 104		High	
Top outlets (last 12 months)	Bee 30, Politico 29, CalMatters 17, Jewish Journal 16, SD Jewish World 13, Center Square 12, Chronicle 11	Nov 2025–Nov 2026	Medium	
LA Times stories	28 → 17 → 2	2024 → 2025 → 2026	Low	blocked site; may be a capture gap; verify in NewsBank/ProQuest
Stories with 1+ reprint	25%; mean 3.8 reprints	all	Medium-High	text-matched; wire chains in no-copy outlets under-grouped
September + October share of stories	33%	2019–2026	High	
Op-eds by Gabriel since 2018	4	2018–2026	High	

9. Caveats: what the data cannot tell, and how to read the newest months

- **Newest weeks are incomplete.** The web search misses roughly 1 in 6 recent stories (print-only, wires, paywalled papers); those arrive with the monthly NewsBank download. Treat October 2026 as 80–85% complete and November as a placeholder (5 stories so far). About a quarter of 2026 stories came only from NewsBank, so any "this month vs last month" comparison before the refresh will understate the newest month.
- **TV and radio are undercounted,** especially LA stations and untitled segments; podcasts were only searched from 2026. The TV decline is real in direction but its size is uncertain.
- **Before 2018 the tracker is thin** (about 100 stories in 25 years) and 2018–2022 was reconstructed from archives, so earlier years' counts are floors.
- **Non-English coverage** was captured systematically only recently (25 stories added on 2026-11-03). Earlier non-English counts are floors, and Korean/Chinese dates can trail US dates by a day.

- **Dates:** 4% of stories carry an estimated or unknown date; 36 are undated and left out of the time charts. About 585 Page cells hold NewsBank scan positions rather than printed page numbers (irrelevant to these counts).
- **Reprint grouping** is text-based (25-word runs covering 90% of both texts). Wire stories in outlets whose text could not be saved (LA Times, AP, Politico) can appear as separate stories, which slightly inflates story counts and deflates reprint counts for those outlets.
- **Tone** is Claude's rating against a rubric, on Originals only, with straight news always Neutral and praise of the bill (not of him) counted as Positive. Read tone as "how the piece frames him," not as sentiment about the policy.
- **Release links** can only be made to stories in the tracker, use rule-based windows (text within 30 days, same-news within about a week), and credit a release when the story coincides with it. The matcher does not know whether a reporter actually read the release.
- **Releases** are only what is posted on gabriel.asmdc.org and the Jewish Caucus site. Media advisories, pitches, social posts and the Speaker's or Governor's releases quoting him are not in the tab, so "coverage without a release" sometimes had another trigger.
- **No times of day,** no reporter emails or pitch records, and no readership figures: "reach" here is a category label per outlet, not an audience number.
- Seventy-two stories have no Topic and 128 no Tone (no saved text); nine have no Reach label.

Method (brief)

- **Tabs and columns used.** Coverage (Story ID, Original or reprint, Date, Outlet, Medium, Format, Reach, Language, Author 1–9, Topic, Bills, Tone, Role, Mention depth, Quoted, Press release, Data Source, Date source); Press releases (Release ID, Date, Title, Source, Release type, In scope, Issue, Gabriel quoted, Legislator 1–6, Other official 1, Bill 1–6, Word count, Copies (rows), Related count); Bills (Bill, Session, Date, Milestone); `code/release_related.json` for the per-story release links and lags; `code/release_texts.json` for the release bodies (quote check). Removed and Unlinked print pages were read only to confirm they hold nothing countable.
- **Coverage universe.** Coverage rows minus the 399 rows marked Press release = Yes (verbatim release copies, hidden in the tracker) and the 2 rows marked In Tracker? = No: 7,423 rows = 3,832 Originals (stories) + 3,591 Reprints. No "Reprint (unverified)" rows remain in this workbook. Reprints were counted by Story ID; reprint lag is the reprint's date minus the Original's.
- **Release analysis.** In-scope releases only. Related stories = release_related.json entries of the tier-1 types (text, nearcopy, quote, bill, topic, anchor, roundup, pre), which is what the tab's Related count holds; "later" and "possible" entries excluded; stories that are themselves release copies excluded (2 entries). Lags come from the file (story date minus release date). Pickup rate, stories, reprints, outlets, reach (Reach contains "Statewide" or "National"), TV/radio and language were aggregated per release and then by type, issue, year, weekday, joint (any Legislator column filled), bill (Bill 1 filled), word count and quote. Weekday, joint and quote comparisons were re-run excluding food safety; "p" values are two-sided permutation tests on mean stories per release (20,000 shuffles).
- **Op-eds:** Role = "Op-ed by Gabriel" plus bylines containing "Jesse Gabriel", minus release reposts bylined to him (Sierra Sun Times, Del Norte Triplicate). Follow-on: same-Topic Originals in the 14 days after vs before.
- **Milestones:** Bills tab rows from 2021 for Introduced (Assembly), Floor vote (Assembly/Senate), Passed both houses, Signed, Vetoed; stories = Originals whose Bills column names the bill, dated −1 to +7 days; "with a release" = an in-scope release naming the bill in Bill 1–6 dated −1 to +2 days.
- **Quotes in releases:** the tab's "Gabriel quoted" column, checked against release bodies with a regular expression for a quoted passage within 160 characters of "Gabriel"; quote length is the word count of such passages.
- **Checks made on surprising numbers:** the Saturday/Sunday release spike (all signing/passage days, so reported as event-driven); the LA Times 2026 drop (flagged as a possible capture gap rather than reported as fact); the

2023 outlet-count peak (204 first-time outlets, mostly one-off syndication of the Skittles story); the Sierra Sun Times "Jesse Gabriel" bylines (release copies, excluded from op-eds); the "Related count" definition (confirmed in `code/reltab.py` as tier-1 only).